

Derek Wood: Senior Product Designer

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Cross-disciplinary product designer with 15+ years of experience. I started in art school, became a front-end engineer, moved into product design, built design systems, and eventually owned products from concept to launch. Along the way I built and taught a product design curriculum, and I'm excited to bring that systems thinking to a team building products that make a meaningful difference.

PERPETUAL EDUCATION (2019-2026)

Product, Curriculum & Platform Design

Designed and built a cross-disciplinary product design program covering the full product lifecycle, from information architecture and accessibility through visual design, engineering, design systems, and product strategy. Created the platform, curriculum, progression model, and supporting systems from scratch, integrating content, projects, critiques, and interactive tools into a cohesive product.

Guided multiple concurrent cohorts over four years, helping designers and engineers develop the shared language, systems thinking, and collaborative habits needed to work effectively on cross-functional product teams. Prototype everything: paper sketches, whiteboards, Figma, code, AI, whatever tested an idea fastest. The curriculum and platform evolved through continuous learner feedback into a self-sustaining, self-paced system.

PXL AGENCY (2018-2019)

Senior Front-End Developer

Developed interactive web experiences for entertainment brands including DreamWorks and Universal. Built dreamworks.com, interactive quiz games, and marketing microsites. Collaborated on pitch brainstorms for film campaigns. Mentored junior developers.

NIAGEN BIOSCIENCE (2017-2018)

Senior Product Designer

Led product design for health supplement that couldn't make FDA-approved claims. Worked with scientists and doctors to translate complex biology into approachable interfaces. Designed health tracking system letting customers monitor energy and wellness metrics in place of human study data.

EARLY CAREER: AGENCIES & CONSULTING (2011-2017)

Full-stack Developer & UX Designer

Multiple full-time and contract roles at agencies and startups. Built responsive, mobile-first websites and educational experiences including game-like systems for clients like AAA Auto Insurance. Introduced teams to version control, modern build tools, and design systems thinking. Early adopter of responsive design and component-based systems.

LIST AT EASE (2025) - CONTRACT

Product Designer / Front End Lead

Green-field real estate platform that redesigns data collection, teaches average people how to prepare and sell their home while integrating licensed realtors to handle the behind-the-scenes legal transactions. Designed core design system and form library from scratch.

BETTERLIFE (2024) - CONTRACT

Product / UI Designer

Financial education mastermind platform scattered across 3rd-party systems. Redesigned dashboards, education system, created design system and living style guide unifying brand designer's work with existing platform structure. R&D for integrated habit tracking app.

EQUIVALENT DESIGN (2022) - CONTRACT

Accessibility Consultant

R&D for accessible SVG and animated graphics that automatically adapt to any environment. Designed accessibility compliance tools and systems to teach teams about accessible graphics through interactive stories.

Speaking & Teaching

Speaker AICAD conference (2024), guest lecturer Turing School, champion for local meetups, active mod in multiple learning communities, and hosting weekly public office hours for designers and developers.

Education

BFA, California College of the Arts (2005). Individualized Major: Printmaking, Painting, cross-disciplinary art and technology. Workshops on DS token architecture with Brad Frost and multi-brand theming at scale with Sam Gordashko.